Chapter 7

O sinivi – The canoe tree (Blackboard Tree)

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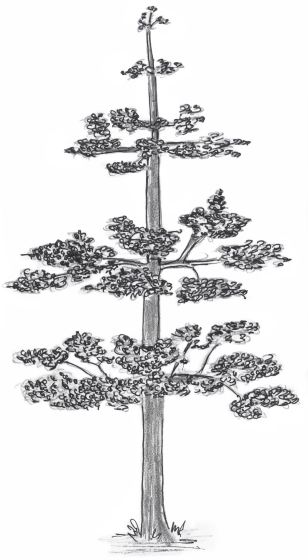


Figure 1: *O naono sinivi* – Canoe tree

Joyce Maion. 2026. *O sinivi* – the canoe tree (blackboard tree). In Ulrike Mosel (ed.), *The material culture of the Teop people of Bougainville*, 97–99. Berlin: Language Science Press. DOI: 10.5281/zenodo.22880240

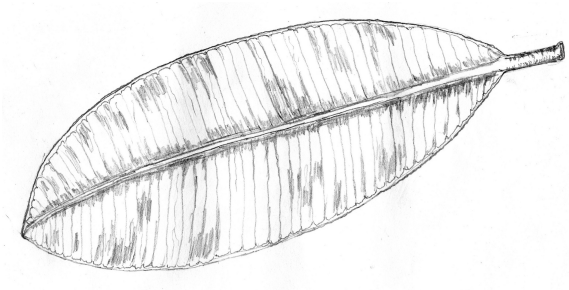


Figure 2: *Paka sinivi* – Leaf of canoe tree

(1)	***O vahutate no naono sinivi.***	**The story of the canoe tree (Blackboard Tree.)**
(2)	*O sinivi na paku raara bona maa naono to dao raara bono mara-makasi, o bio ae o naosinivi.*	We make the canoe from the trees that are called *maramakasi*, *bio* (a Ficus species), and canoe tree.[1]
(3)	*Evehee enaa kahi vahutate koa ni nom o naosinivi.*	But I'll talk only about the canoe tree.
(4)	*O naono vai o sinivi na taba beera kurusu kiri nana bona tavaan to popo rori teo toro mohina.*	This canoe tree is a very important thing for the people who live on an island.
(5)	*Bea tavaan tara bono naono sinivi o sii rutaa beve pura nana rasuu,*	When the people see a little canoe tree growing in the jungle,
(6)	*eori repaa kiu kahi ni bari,*	they clear the ground around it,
(7)	*ore paa sun nana tea mamana.*	so that it stands in the open.
(8)	*Eve repaa pura hiava komana, be-ori kikira batari bari.*	Then it grows up, while they are looking after it.
(9)	*Beo meho aba tara bono naosinivi paa kiu kahi ni vori,*	If other people see that the canoe tree has been freed from the under-growth around it,
(10)	*ori paa kona voen, a aba to paa kiu kahi niu bona, eve to vaahito nana. Saka antee haa riori tea mosi.*	they recognize that the person who has done this work is the one who owns it. They cannot cut it down.
(11)	*Eori to popo rori rapana kasuana bara tea maa toro mohina, toro tei mi bono sinivi,*	Those who live along the coast or on the islands must have a canoe,

(12)	*tea tabae beori hiki, eori repaa hiki ta taba toro hae ori tea vagana.*	because if they don't, they wouldn't have anything to board and go fishing.
(13)	*Beori rake mee tea hua pahana tea maa meha maa toro mohina.*	Also, when they want to paddle across the bay to the islands.
(14)	*Bea aba hiki to naosinivi mene paku sinivi,*	If someone does not have a canoe tree for making a canoe,
(15)	*toro paku ta hanana vai toro vaahito kaakoo me to sinivi kiri bona vuu tom sinana.*	he or she should find some other way to acquire a canoe for the family.
(16)	*Meara toro kikira nio naosinivi eara mene hiki sinivi.*	We must look after the canoe tree, otherwise we would be without canoes.



Figure 3: *Sinivi suuna* – Indigenous canoe

[1]A further tree used for canoes and mentioned in the TLC is a terminalia species called *marakaoto*, see https://dictionaria.clld.org/units/teop-marakaoto